
Hackles Mentors • Semester Calendar

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · quillsup.org · October 2026

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A sixteen-week plan for a fall or spring semester, built for a community college: commuter students, evening classes and short windows. Adjust to your academic calendar [LOCAL]. Schools' calendars also matter: avoid their testing windows and breaks.

TO VERIFY

Status: DRAFT. Dates are examples. Safer Internet Day (February) and National Cybersecurity Awareness Month (October) are natural anchors for events [VERIFY dates].

Calendar

WEEKS	PHASE	TASKS	OWNER
Before week 1	Prepare	Documents reviewed by counsel and HR; insurance confirmed; school agreements signed; coordinator and advisor named; budget approved [COUNSEL/HR TO CONFIRM]	Advisor, coordinator
1 to 3	Recruit	Club visits, classroom announcements, info sessions (one daytime, one evening), social posts (no photos of children)	Coordinator, club leaders
2 to 4	Apply and interview	Applications, interviews, references; consent for background checks	Coordinator, advisor
3 to 5	Screen	Background checks, host school clearances	HR, coordinator
4	Training session A	Four-hour training, daytime option	Trainer, counselor
5	Training session B	Four-hour training, evening or weekend option	Trainer, counselor
6	Placement	Assign mentors to events and Station Leads; brief schools with the roster	Coordinator
7	Rehearsal	Station practice, equipment check, event run-through	Station Leads
8	Event 1 (pilot or shadow)	First school visit. New mentors shadow a Station Lead	Coordinator, advisor
9	Debrief 1	Mentor debrief; incident review; fix the plan	Coordinator, advisor
10 to 12	Events 2 to 4	School and library visits; one evening family event if a school asks	All
12	Check-in	Advisor and coordinator review of safety, hours and feedback	Advisor
13	Event 5 or on-campus Hackles Day	A larger event, if schools come to campus (see transport checklist)	All
14	Reflection	Mentors write reflections; hours logged	Mentors
15	Recognition	Certificates, badges, thank-you notes to schools	Coordinator
16	Close	Impact tracker finalised (aggregate counts only); report to the dean; plan next term	Coordinator, advisor

A typical event day (3 hours, mornings)

TIME	TASK
7:45	Mentors arrive; sign in; brief with Station Lead
8:15	Meet the school contact; visitor badges
8:30	Stations open with the teacher leading
11:15	Close; thank the teacher
11:30	Debrief; end-of-event check-in forms; clean up

Evening and weekend options

- Evening training (two 2-hour sessions) in weeks 4 and 5.
- Saturday morning events with a library or community group.
- Evening family nights with a school (adults and children together), where a school or library staff member leads.
- Remote tasks for commuters: art for passports, poster design, card cutting, impact tracker support, writing the thank-you notes.

Planning checklist (each event)

- ☐ School agreement current
- ☐ Mentor roster cleared and confirmed
- ☐ Station Leads assigned and briefed
- ☐ Ratios met
- ☐ Rooms, routes and accessibility checked
- ☐ Materials printed and counted
- ☐ Incident forms and emergency contact sheet
- ☐ Coordinator and advisor reachable
- ☐ Weather and contingency plan
- ☐ Teacher feedback form ready (no student data)

Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled study.